



United States
Attorney's Office
Southern District of West Virginia



Lisa G. Johnston Named Acting United States Attorney for the Southern District of West Virginia

Monday, March 3, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Southern District of
West Virginia



CHARLESTON, W.Va. – Lisa G. Johnston has been named the Acting United States Attorney for the Southern District of West Virginia. As Acting United States Attorney, Johnston is the chief federal law enforcement officer for the Southern District of West Virginia, which covers 23 counties, and oversees all federal criminal prosecutions as well as the litigation of all civil matters in which the United States has an interest.

"I am honored to serve as Acting United States Attorney and pledge to continue to fulfill the vital mission of the Department of Justice," Johnston said. "On behalf of this office and its dedicated attorneys and staff, I look forward to working closely and collaboratively with our law enforcement partners to protect

the public, enforce the law fairly and consistently, and promote respect for the legal system and the rule of law.”

Johnston previously served as the Acting United States Attorney for the Southern District of West Virginia from February 2021 to October 2021. She joined the U.S. Attorney's Office in the Southern District of West Virginia in August 2006. Since January 2018, Johnston has served as First Assistant United States Attorney, the second most-senior official in the United States Attorney's Office tasked with overseeing the operations of the criminal, civil and administrative sections of the United States Attorney's Office.

Johnston began her 37-year career in the Northern District of West Virginia, where she served as a Special Assistant United States Attorney and then as an Assistant United States Attorney. In October 2001, Johnston accepted a detail with the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives (ATF) Chief Counsel's Office where she served as a legal advisor to ATF employees in the Louisville Field Division. In August 2005, Johnston accepted a detail with the United States Attorney's Office for the Southern District of New York, where she handled immigration appeals.

Throughout her extensive career as an Assistant United States Attorney, Johnston has handled investigations and prosecutions of federal criminal laws involving crimes against children, firearms, violence, drug trafficking, health care fraud, immigration, and other white-collar offenses.

As Acting United States Attorney, Johnston oversees a staff of 34 attorneys and 41 non-attorney personnel located in offices in Charleston, Huntington, and Beckley.

A native of Moundsville, West Virginia, Johnston earned a Juris Doctor degree from the West Virginia University College of Law in 1988. She graduated Cum Laude from West Virginia University with a Bachelor of Science degree in Journalism in 1984.

A copy of this press release is located on the website of the [U.S. Attorney's Office](#) for the Southern District of West Virginia.

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Updated March 4, 2025

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Southern District of West Virginia

